

WiFi standards of wireless technology. It essentially enables users at the location to share information and resources, like printers etc, with each other. In the earlier days Novell used to be the defacto choice for networking software but these days Windows has more or less taken over the field completely. Most networks these days are Ethernet based as it is relatively easy to deploy and robust enough to give trouble free service. However, with the advent of Wi-Fi technology there is a strong move towards wireless networks or wireless LANs as they are called due to the relative ease of connection and the lack of the need for physical wiring in a location.

7.2.25 MAN

Metropolitan Area Networks—see LAN.

7.2.26 PAN

Personal Area Network is the network you create with your devices, usually using some form of wireless technology. Using Bluetooth to communicate between two PCs, your PC and your smartphone, transferring files, etc. are all examples of PANs in action.



Multiple devices interacting via Bluetooth in a PAN

7.2.27 Sandbox

An isolated part of the system or network where new or unknown programs are first installed and monitored for proper behaviour before being transferred to the main system. For example, all new Web sites that Google's search bot discovers are placed in a sandbox for a period of 60-90 days. They are then progressively made available in the search engine results page.

7.2.28 Search Bot

Short for search robot. A software program that crawls the internet, runs through all the pages it finds and reports back to the search engine details of everything on the page. The search engine